

Common Networking & Security Ports

Key Common Ports — Services & Purpose

Port	Protocol / Service	Purpose / Typical Use
7	Echo (TCP/UDP)	Old diagnostic service — ping-like echo. Rarely used now.
20 / 21	FTP (data / control)	File Transfer Protocol — standard (but insecure) file transfers.
22	SSH / SCP / SFTP	Secure remote shell/login; secure file transfer; port forwarding.
23	Telnet	Text-based remote login (unencrypted). Legacy.
25	SMTP	Email routing / mail-server communication.
42	WINS Replication / WINS name-service	(Windows network name management) — can be vulnerable in local networks.
43	WHOIS	Domain/Internet-registration lookup queries.
49	TACACS (legacy)	Authentication & access control for network devices (legacy).
53	DNS (TCP/UDP)	Domain name resolution (domain ↔ IP). Fundamental for all network activity.
67 / 68	DHCP / BOOTP (UDP)	Dynamic IP assignment (server / client) — auto-network configuration.
69	TFTP (UDP)	Lightweight file transfer (often used in network / embedded devices) — no authentication.
79	Finger	Old protocol for user information (largely obsolete now).
80	HTTP	Web traffic (unencrypted) — webpages, web apps.
88	Kerberos	Network authentication protocol (common in enterprise Windows/AD)
110	POP3	Email retrieval (old standard)

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113	Ident	Query to identify user of a connection (rarely used now)
119	NNTP	Usenet / news service (rare in modern context)
123	NTP (UDP)	Network Time Protocol — time synchronization across devices.
135	RPC EPMAP / MS-RPC Endpoint Mapper	Used in Windows networking / remote procedure calls — often targeted in Windows attacks.
137 / 138 / 139	NetBIOS (Name / Datagram / Session services)	Legacy Windows network name & file-sharing protocols. Often abused in local networks.
143	IMAP	Email retrieval / synchronization protocol (more modern than POP3)
161 / 162	SNMP (agent / trap)	Network device management and monitoring (routers, switches, printers, etc.) — often unencrypted.
389	LDAP	Directory service (e.g. Active Directory, user databases). Used for authentication / directory lookups.
443	HTTPS	Secure Web (HTTP over TLS/SSL) — default for encrypted web traffic.
445	SMB / Microsoft-DS	Windows file sharing, Active Directory, network shares — high risk in internal networks.
464	Kerberos (password changes)	Used for changing credentials in Kerberos environments (AD / enterprise)
465	SMTP over TLS/SSL (SMTPS)	Secure mail submission / transfer (encrypted SMTP)
500	IPSec / IKE / ISAKMP (UDP)	VPN / secure channel setup protocols.
514	syslog (UDP)	Centralised logging — devices send logs over network to a syslog server.
631	IPP (Internet Printing Protocol)	Network printing services.
636	LDAPS (LDAP over SSL/TLS)	Secure version of directory service communications.

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902 / 903	VMware hypervisor / virtualization management (TCP/UDP)	Management interfaces for virtualization platforms — often inside networks.
989 / 990	FTPS (FTP over TLS/SSL) — data/control	Secure file transfer protocol (encrypted) replacing plain FTP.
993	IMAPS (IMAP over SSL/TLS)	Secure email retrieval via IMAP.
995	POP3S (POP3 over SSL/TLS)	Secure email retrieval via POP3.
3306	MySQL (database)	Default port for MySQL database server — common in web-apps and backend infrastructure.
3389	RDP (Remote Desktop Protocol)	Windows remote desktop / remote GUI access — often targeted for remote compromise.
5060 / 5061	SIP / SIP-TLS (VoIP signaling)	Voice-over-IP setup / communication protocols — used in telephony, VoIP infrastructure.